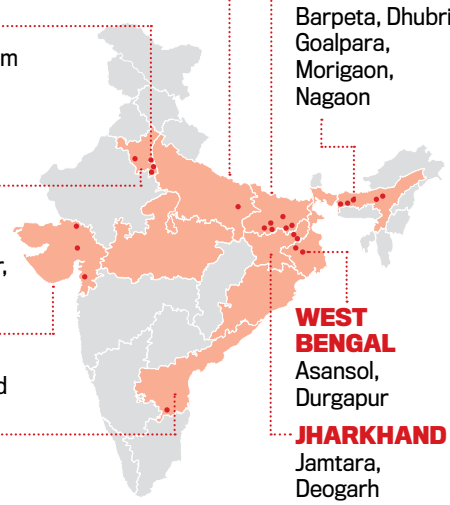
INDIA'S CYBERCRIME HOTSPOTS

While Jharkhand's Jamtara district was once the hub of cybercrime in India, the menace has now spread to many parts of the country



DELHI
Ashok Nagar, Uttam Nagar, Shakarpur, Harkesh Nagar, Okhla, Azadpur

HARYANA
Mewat, Bhiwani, Palwal, Nuh, Manota, Hasanpur, Hathan Gaon

GUJARAT
Banaskantha, Surat, Ahmedabad

ANDHRA PRADESH
Chittoor

UTTAR PRADESH
Azamgarh

BIHAR
Banka, Begusarai, Jamui, Nawada, Nalanda, Gaya

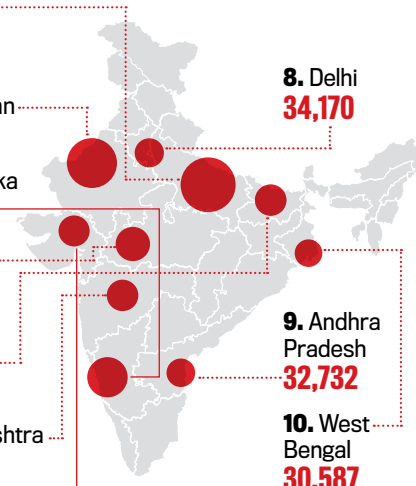
ASSAM
Barpeta, Dhubri, Goalpara, Morigaon, Nagaon

WEST BENGAL
Asansol, Durgapur

JHARKHAND
Jamtara, Deogarh

TOP 10 STATES WITH MOST COMPLAINTS

Statewise break-up of the 700,000 complaints in April 2023 on 1930, the helpline run by the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal



1. Uttar Pradesh **120,938**
2. Rajasthan **100,345**
3. Karnataka **65,340**
4. Madhya Pradesh **47,382**
5. Bihar **40,057**
6. Maharashtra **39,909**
7. Gujarat **38,735**
8. Delhi **34,170**
9. Andhra Pradesh **32,732**
10. West Bengal **30,587**

them, and the technology they are using to do so. Each of these cases is a cautionary tale, and knowing them can save you from falling into their clutches.

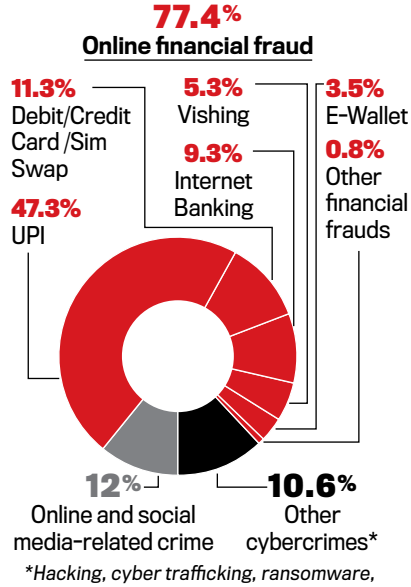
THE DECEPTION GAME

The cyber criminal's journey begins with hunting for prey. The dark web is a rich resource here, where you can access the personal data of a million individuals for as little as Rs 5,000. Such data has their name, mobile number, address, bank, Aadhaar or PAN card details. Criminals may also track a person's credit history or spending habits. Corrupt bank officials are another loaded vein, ready to be mined for information on high net worth clients or retired government officials whose life savings are parked in bank FDs. Data breaches have also become common as companies outsource their customer support functions to third-party vendors.

Having identified their victims, cyber criminals execute the next level of fraud—procuring a preactivated SIM card, even though the government banned their sale in 2012. This is a whole racket in itself. A preactivated SIM card can be put into use immediately and discarded once it has served its purpose. Initially, egged on by incentive schemes from service providers, unscrupulous retailers had started selling such SIM cards indiscriminately, without verifying KYC documents, or by forging the bank verification process itself. West Bengal, particularly Murshidabad, was for long the hub of such operations drawing on its proximity to Jamtara, the ground zero of cybercrime. In the race to sell as many SIM cards as possible, retailers started issuing multiple such cards in a single person's name. Some persuaded gullible villagefolk to buy SIM cards in return for free talk time or cash, or even a light bulb! Others carried Aadhaar card biometric readers to take the Aadhaar-linked fingerprints of innocent villagers more than once, using them to generate two or more numbers of different service

CYBERCRIME TRENDS

Break-up of internet offences between Jan. 2020 and Jul. 2023



**Hacking, cyber trafficking, ransomware, cryptocurrency frauds, cyber terrorism and deepfake crimes; Source: Future Crime Research Foundation*